
UNIT 10 A CASE STUDY OF MAZDOOR KISAN SHAKTI SANGATHAN*

A Case Study of Mazdoor
Kisan Shakti Sangathan

Structure

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10.0 OBJECTIVES

After reading this Unit, you should be able to:

- Describe the concept of Mazdoor Kisan Shakti Sangathan (MKSS);
- Discuss the genesis and growth of MKSS;
- Explain the importance of people's participation in democracy; and
- Examine the major achievements of MKSS.

10.1 INTRODUCTION

Mazdoor Kisan Shakti Sangathan (MKSS) is a classic example of the role of social movements and NGOs in policymaking. By now we are clear about the significance of NGOs and social movements in a democracy. We read about them in our previous Units of this Course. MKSS is one of the most prominent Indian social movements, which works towards a just and equal society, and has been instrumental in the implementation of Right to Information (RTI) Act in 2005. MKSS is also known as the Association for Empowerment of Labourers and Farmers, which is a grassroots non-political organisation. It was founded on 1 May, 1990, in the remote village of Rajasthan, with the mission of establishing and ensuring access to participatory democratic processes for poor peasants and workers.

MKSS was the result of a struggle for community land held illegally by a feudal landlord. Initially, it struggled to ensure the payment of minimum wages to the workers. Over time, in the process of understanding the causes for the delay or denial of payment of wages, it broadened its ambit and started working for the proper implementation of people's rights, ensuring transparency in government activities and holding it accountable to public. It realised that transparency and

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accountability was the basis of good governance and rights of people. Right to Information is the foundation for ensuring transparency and accountability of the government. So, this struggle culminated into the passing of Right to Information Act.

This is one of the very few grassroots level organisations, which could be credited for mobilising the people and ensuring their participation in government demonstrations and *Jansunwais*. In *Jansunwais*, officials get in touch with the public and common people can ask them any question, raise any enquiry or bring any matter of corruption to light.

It was the struggle of MKSS, which forced the government of Rajasthan to enact and implement the Right to Information legislation for the first time in the country. Its success inspired similar demands in other states too. Many state governments and Government of India followed in its footsteps and passed Right to Information Act. Even after championing the cause of Right to Information, MKSS is still working towards building a stronger and more transparent democracy, fighting corruption and creating awareness in the country. This noteworthy contribution of MKSS has won itself global credentials. In this Unit, we will discuss the genesis, growth, significance and achievements of MKSS.

10.2 GENESIS OF MAZDOOR KISAN SHAKTI SANGATHAN (MKSS)

In order to understand the objectives and functioning of MKSS, it is very important to understand the background, which led to the formation of this Sanghathan. It was founded on May 1, 1990 by Aruna Roy, Nikhil Dey and Shankar Singh in the village of Devdungari, Rajasthan. The movement, however, was not formed in one day, but is the result of a long-drawn struggle against exploitation of poor people of Rajasthan.

In Sohargarh village in Deogarh Tehsil of Rajsamand District, a land struggle against a feudal landowner made a close team of activists, who had recently come in contact with each other at the Social Work and Research Centre (SWRC), Tilonia in Ajmer District, where Aruna Roy and Shankar Singh worked. SWRC was a voluntary organisation founded by Aruna Roy's husband Sanjit Roy.

Aruna Roy quit her job of an Indian Administrative Service (IAS) Officer in 1975 to work with SWRC. Shankar Singh was a local politician who was concerned about exploitation, inequality and poverty in rural Rajasthan. Nikhil Dey had given up his studies in the US and had joined Aruna Roy in 1983. These three were working in Devdungri village to help poor access basic political and democratic rights. They were carrying out a study for Union Government's Ministry of Resource Development, to study issues related to the participation of the poor in the government's poverty alleviation programmes.

They came into contact with a policeman called Lal Singh, who actively participated against the exploitation of constables at the hands of senior officers. For his activism he was dismissed from police. Lal Singh lived in Sohargarh village, which was gravely exploited by Jagirdaar Hari Singh. He had illegally controlled the common land of village. He used to raise fine on villagers if their

cattle grazed on it or if they collected firewood from it. Lal Singh brought this matter to the attention of Aruna Roy. They persuaded villagers to fight for their rights and challenge the dictatorial ways of Hari Singh.

In 1988, under Government's programme of "Prashasan Gaon ki Oar", the Sub-Divisional Magistrate (SDM) held a public hearing in the Panchayat of Tal. Aruna Roy along with her team challenged Hari Singh's illegal control over a piece of 25 hectare land. To their good luck, patwari of that village provided them all necessary information regarding plot number and other details. Without this formal information, they would not have been able to present their case to SDM. Usually public authorities do not cooperate with public, but somehow due to the help of patwari and his given information, they won their case in front of SDM. This 25 hectare land was transferred to local people. This first win made Aruna Roy and her team understand the importance of access to information in their fight against corruption.

While the struggle in Sohargarh was still going on, Aruna Roy started getting complaints of non-payment of minimum wages to the workers. Central Rajasthan was a drought prone area. Due to small holdings and infertile land, their people mainly depended upon drought relief works of government. Despite their full work, workers were not given their bare minimum wages stipulated for that work. Dadi Rapat was one such site, where work was carried out by State Irrigation Department. Here, most of the workers were from Sohargarh village. When Aruna Roy's team investigated the issue, they found that work measurement mechanism was faulty. Though workers were given individual work, they were paid collectively. Officers used to include bogus names in the list, and the payments were made way below the fixed minimum wages. On the intervention of MKSS all 140 workers there went on strike.

Due to adamant struggle of workers, State Famine Commissioner and Executive Engineer visited Dadi Rapat in 1989. He found that the work was completed as per targets, and he directed for full payment of minimum wages. Despite his directions, workers were still paid lower than minimum wages. They understood that they cannot avail their minimum wages, unless they carry out a collective struggle against this type of corruption. It was this realisation that led to the formation of MKSS on the Labour Day of 1990. In a rally of 1000 people from 27 villages, MKSS was formed with the objective of collective struggle against non-payment of minimum wages. After its formation, MKSS organised a hunger strike in front of the SDM Office, which was lifted only when the District Collector assured the payment of proper wages.

Check Your Progress 1

Note: i) Use the space given below for your answers.

ii) Check your answers with those given at the end of the Unit.

1. When and for what purpose was the MKSS founded?

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2. Discuss the importance of the struggle of Sohargarh village in the wake of MKSS.

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3. Write a note on the Dadi Rapat incident.

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10.3 GROWTH OF MKSS

‘Jansunwais’ Innovation of MKSS

In 1991, MKSS launched another indefinite hunger strike in front of the SDM office in Bhim. This was carried out to ensure justice for 12 labourers of Barar Panchayat. These workers were denied minimum wages despite their completion and accurate measurement of work. They submitted their case through proper channel, sent notices but all went in vain. Thus, to help them, 5 people belonging to five districts of Pali, Jaipur, Rajsamand, Ajmer and Baran sat on a strike. On fifth day of the strike, police crackdown took place. Next day, the MKSS started a strike against police oppression. They won this battle, as Rural Development Secretary of Government of India stopped the central assistance to Rajasthan for Jawahar Rozgaar Yojna, since it violated the Minimum Wages Act, 1948. As a response, Rajasthan government ordered payment of minimum wages to the 12 Barar workers.

This case made MKSS deduce that it cannot deal with cases of non-payment of wages in a piecemeal approach. Bureaucracy did not pay heed to hunger strikes, since it was least bothered about the lives of the poor. It needed comprehensive strategy to deal with the issue. This led MKSS’ new innovation of *Jansunwai* or public hearings, which gave a platform for collective struggle of workers against non-payment of wages and popularise the demand for accountability and transparency in administration. Now, let us see how the *Jansunwais* came about.

During their struggle for minimum wages, MKSS understood the importance of access to official records and public documents. By this information, they could discover various frauds like fake muster rolls, overbilling in purchase, underpayment of wages etc. This they could make possible with the cooperation of some officer or the other who provided the desired documents and information sought by the MKSS workers.

This led to an awakening among the MKSS that information given by administrative officers was in fact a legitimate right of the people, and could do wonders for increasing transparency and accountability in the administration. With the reference case of Kesar Singh from Bagmal, Ajmer District needs special attention. In this case, Kesar Singh lodged a complaint that the Panchayat had

used his tractor for several construction works of panchayat, but he was not paid any money for that. Despite his request, sarpanch denied to show the records.

On the advice of MKSS, Kesar Singh demanded information from the panchayat samiti, which refused to show the records. Matter then reached the Block Development Officer (BDO), who ordered the payment of his dues, but refused to give him copies of the records. Adamant Kesar Singh then approached the SDO and with pressure being put by MKSS and the larger collective of community, he was allowed to note down records for a year. As expected, there were fake names in muster rolls along with other anomalies. The sarpanch tried to put pressure on Kesar Singh through Caste Panchayat and offered him payment even with interest, but he refused to take any money. He demanded an investigation and appropriate action against the culprits. Investigation brought to light rampant corruption in payment of wages and works of panchayat. An FIR was filed against the Sarpanch. Kesar Singh got his money back. However, the police soon closed the file despite ample proof of corruption.

MKSS understood that these cases of corruption should be brought to the fore at a public platform. Public exposure of corrupt officials in their view could build pressure on government. It could also enhance people's involvement and accountability of authorities to the public. This understanding gave birth to the idea of *Jansunwais* along with the demand of Right to Information.

Jansunwai of Kot Kirana

The first *Jansunwai* was conducted on 2nd December, 1994 at Kot Kirana of Pali district. Here a person sought the help of MKSS, when he was denied minimum wages for his work done for panchayat. MKSS demanded copies of all the muster rolls where he had worked. The access to records was refused by sarpanch and secretary, but the BDO provided the records to MKSS. When a number of anomalies were found in the records, its information was made public. An announcement of *Jansunwai* on 2nd December was then made.

The panchayat officials tried to make people hostile and distributed liquor as bribe to ensure that no one speaks out at the hearing. People gathered in large numbers as a reaction to prevalent corruption. They fearlessly spoke against the fraud and corruption exposed in the records. On the basis of people's affidavits, FIRs were filed. The MLA there took the case to court to save the officials. Due to power of money and muscle, the witnesses turned hostile and the case was closed. But this public hearing left an unforgettable mark in the history of India. Its impact could be felt at the state secretariat in Jaipur. This hearing was followed by two other hearings in Bhim and Vijaypur, in the same month.

Jansunwai of Jawaja

In January 1995, a very interesting public hearing took place in Jawaja (Ajmer District). In this case, access to records was completely denied. So, there was no documentary evidence. But so many irregularities were reported from different sources. So many people openly gave their testimony on corruption. The impact of hearing increased manifold, when concerned gram sewaks (panchayat secretaries) returned the money that they had allegedly taken as bribe for giving housing grants. This demonstrated the positive impact of the power of people's participation in administration.

In April 1995, the then Chief Minister, Bhairon Singh Shekhawat announced in the state assembly that the Right to Information (RTI) will be given to the people.

He also informed the house that corruption will not be tolerated at any cost. In all cases of corruption, money will be recovered from the concerned officials. MKSS organised a number of *Jansunwais* between December 1994 and April 1995. *Jansunwais* mainly depended upon the information provided by any sympathetic officer. Since it was not mandatory for public bodies to provide any information, MKSS realised the importance of Right to Information. During its *Jansunwais*, it started demanding the same.

Due to the relentless efforts of MKSS and their continuous demands for information, the Right to Information Act was passed in the state assembly. It provided that on payment of a prescribed fee, people could get details of expenditure on the work carried out by the government in the last five years. For the first time, in the Indian history, government took up bold and exclusively citizen-centric measures. This gesture of the then chief minister was widely appreciated. It encouraged similar demands in other states too.

Protest of Beawar

Despite the chief minister's promise, nothing concrete was done by the office of the director of panchayats. This compelled MKSS to go on an indefinite hunger strike in the town of Beawar in April 1996. This was MKSS' historic 40 days long dharna for the Right to Information. Interesting feature of this protest was the demand of a political right, which was the basis of good governance. Instead of wages, compensation, people demanded the real power-the information of government records. People from all across Rajasthan started moving to Beawar. People identified this struggle as their own and got fully involved in it. They themselves collected around 46 thousand rupees. Vendors provided free vegetables. Doctors offered their services willingly. Cultural aspect of the protest was noteworthy. Through puppet shows, devotional songs of *bhajan mandalies*, *nukkad nataks*, the people started supporting the protesters and demanding the Right to Information.

This protest caught the attention of the entire nation. People from different parts of the country like journalists, artists, lawyers started visiting Beawar. People developed a slogan of "Hum Jaanenge, Hum Jiyenge" in support of the protest's goals. As a result, panchayats were issued an order to implement the Right to Information Act. But it allowed only inspection and noting down of the information with hand, it did not allow photocopy of documents. MKSS continued its struggle and demanded that Right to Information should be implemented in the form and spirit as chief minister had promised. In 1997, panchayat bodies' rules were amended and government allowed the photocopy of the documents. After continuous struggle, Rajasthan state's Right to Information Act was executed in May 2000.

Check Your Progress 2

Note: i) Use the space given below for your answers.

ii) Check your answers with those given at the end of the Unit.

1. Examine the importance of Beawar Dharna.

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2. Write a note on the *Jansunwai* protests of Kot Kirana.

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10.4 ACHIEVEMENTS OF MKSS

MKSS has set an example of successful struggle for better governance. Its biggest achievement is enactment of Right to Information Act by the states, as well as the central government. But this Act is just an instrument to achieve the larger goal of MKSS that is transparent, accountable and participatory administration. This is to the credit of MKSS' noteworthy contribution that Aruna Roy, one of its foremost leaders, was awarded with prestigious 'Ramon Magsaysay Award' in the year 2000. This prize is also known as Asian Nobel Prize. It was given for the recognition of her work in community leadership, which she provided through MKSS. In 2010, Ms. Aruna Roy received the Lal Bahadur Shastri National Award. The success of MKSS can be understood in the following ways:

Participation

The biggest contribution of MKSS is that it has brought to the fore people's participation in democratic government processes like no other movement has. Its unique method of *Jansunwais* has given voice to the unheard and unattended. MKSS' volunteers initiate questions in public hearings. Slowly, villagers gather courage and lead the hearing. They ask questions, and seek information on performance of public authorities. The kind of struggle that took place at Beawar for 40 days proved that MKSS had penetrated amongst the masses.

The struggle was supported by commoners, their local style (puppet shows, bhajans etc.). It has given courage to people to stand for their own rights. In *Jansunwais*, when officials are face to face answering the questions of public, it gives real exposure to public. It makes people realise that they can supervise, enquire, and ask questions to officers about their own money. This participation is of highest level and takes democracy to the grassroots level. It is estimated that about 60-80 lakh people use RTI per year. This fact is ample to prove the point we are making here.

Empowerment through Information

Another laurel to the credit of MKSS is that it has ensured empowerment of people by providing them information of the documents, procedures, performance of administration. It is through the efforts of MKSS that Right to Information Act has been passed not only in Rajasthan, but at other states' and central government levels as well. Without information, people have no say in government and administration.

MKSS trains public in demanding, accessing and using information. This makes the community empowered. They seek information from administration, wherever there is any discrepancy in implementation of the Rule of Law. This can bring corrupt officials to book and put them behind the bars. So, under the fear of RTI, officials restrain to do anything contrary to rules, as they are answerable under

the RTI Act. This fear empowers the people. They develop a faith in system that it will do justice to them and they are not simply at the mercy of administrative officials. This empowerment of common people helps in realising and strengthening of democracy.

Accountability

MKSS started its journey as a war against corruption. Increasing accountability of administration was one of its main aims. MKSS has also successfully achieved this target. Through RTI and *Jansunwais*, public can make officials accountable to them. They can check accounts, find discrepancies and question the officials in front of an entire village. An officer in-charge has no option but to answer all the questions. This type of responsibility forces administration to be vigilant and honest during *Jansunwais*. This power holds the entire administration accountable to public for every single penny expended by them.

Social Audits

Jansunwais of MKSS have institutionalised a noble technique of social audits of local government bodies. In social audits, Gram Sabha of a village carries out the audit in front of an entire village. It checks if money used for public interest matches with the amount displayed in accounts. It brings into light discrepancies and ensures transparency in government works. Rajasthan government had asked MKSS to conduct about 6-8 social audits of the panchayats, where it has spent a considerable amount during previous year.

The state governments provide MKSS with all necessary information on expenditure and names of officers who have incurred it. MKSS' team visits village well in advance of the social audit to be conducted. It gathers information about actual outlays of money and during audit all expenses are discussed. In proceedings of social audit, villagers decide if money has been actually spent on the purpose shown in accounts. This has impacted governmental working positively.

Transparency in NGOs

The greater success lies in the fact that it has ensured transparency not only in government institution, but also in non-governmental organisations or NGOs. They do not accept any funds from the government. They raise money from community and individuals. They themselves present their accounts during *Jansunwais*. Hence, they promote a culture of transparency and accountability all around.

Changed Equation between Government and Public

MKSS changed the equation between government and public. Before its struggle, people were at the receiving end. They could not question the government. They were at the mercy of governmental bureaucracy, which under the cloud of secrecy, was often into rampant corruption. But after MKSS' struggle for transparency and accountability, especially after RTI, officers have become cautious about their responsibility to people. They think of RTI before committing anything that is contrary to rules.

National Rural Employment Guarantee Act

MKSS has started its struggle to ensure minimum wages for the workers. In Rajasthan due to poor rainfall, people mostly depend upon drought relief work

of the government for their livelihood. In the process of working on records of panchayats for these relief measures, MKSS became closely attached to the issue of work and wages. After ensuring the transparency in wages, MKSS asked for guarantee of wages through minimum employment assured by government. Along with other social institutions, it raised the demand for extension of work guarantee taking the example of Maharashtra State Employment Guarantee Act 1977 (Government of Maharashtra, 2013).

Check Your Progress 3

Note: i) Use the space given below for your answers.

ii) Check your answers with those given at the end of the Unit.

1. How does RTI help in social audits?

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2. Discuss the relationship between RTI and accountability.

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10.5 CONCLUSION

The Case Study of the MKSS is a classic example of understanding the impact of social movements on policymaking. It represents the common will of people to hold administration accountable and ensure true democracy in the nation. MKSS' struggle for RTI and its victory in the same is a clear manifestation of how people's participation can change the face of government, and turn governance into transparent, fair and just system. Its long journey of struggle also signifies that nothing comes easy.

We need persistent and honest efforts to achieve something worthy. That is what the MKSS did. Aruna Roy, Nikhil Dey and Shankar Singh signify the importance of dedicated and committed team, which has always kept the public interest above its self-interest. Their team's honesty, integrity, commitment has been the real strength, which infused life into the MKSS and never let it bend in front of the pressure built by government and administration. We need to remember that when people come in open for some cause and are determined to achieve the same, nothing is impossible. In a democracy, people's voice reigns supreme. They just need to be aware about their rights, get organised and stand together. The MKSS personifies that people are very powerful in a democracy and can make government officers pay for their mistakes. This Unit brought the significance and working of the inimitable MKSS into limelight.

10.6 GLOSSARY

Civil Society: Organisations of a society which are non-governmental, voluntary and private. They aim to promote common good of people and fall between the State and the market.

Jansunwais: Innovation of MKSS to hold officials accountable to people. In *Jansunwais*, all villagers gather and question the officials for the public works done by them.

MKSS: Mazdoor Kisan Shakti Sangathan (MKSS) is a non-governmental and non-political organisation, which works for ensuring the democratic rights of peasants and labourers. It has been the major force behind the Right to Information legislation all over the country.

NGO: A Non-Profit Organisation or Non-Government Organisation that operates independent of government. It is created to address a social, economic or political issue. It is a pertinent part of the Civil Society.

Right to Information (RTI) Act: It is an Act passed by the Government of India in 2005. It enables citizens to get information from the public authorities.

Social Movement: As a part of Civil Society, it is a collective and sustained campaign of people who come together to achieve common goals with larger social and political implications.

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10.8 ANSWERS TO CHECK YOUR PROGRESS EXERCISES

Check Your Progress 1

1. Your answer should include the following points:

- Mazdoor Kisan Shakti Sangathan (MKSS) was founded on 1st May, 1990.
- It attempts to ensure the access of participatory democratic processes for poor peasants and workers.
- Initially, it struggled to ensure the payment of minimum wages to the workers.

- Over time in the process of understanding the causes for the delay or denial of payment of wages, it broadened its ambit and started working for the proper implementation of people's rights specially the Right to Information.
- Strengthening of democratic values have resulted in increased accountability.
- Increased demand for public participation and accountability of administration.
- Even after championing the cause of Right to Information, MKSS is still working towards building a stronger and transparent democracy, fighting corruption, creating awareness and responsible citizenry in the country.

2. Your answer should include the following points:

- Incident of Sohargarh village struggle throws light on the importance of information in the fight against corruption and ensuring justice.
- Sohargarh village was gravely exploited by jaagirdar Hari Singh. He had illegally taken control of the common land of village.
- He used to raise fine on villagers if their cattle grazed on it or they collected firewood from it.
- When this matter came to the attention of Aruna Roy, her team persuaded villagers to fight for their rights and challenge Hari Singh.
- In 1988, under Government's programme of "Prashasan Gaon ki Oar" the SDM held a public hearing in the Panchayat of Tal. Aruna Roy along with her team challenged a piece of 25 hectare land under Hari Singh's illegal control.
- With the help of patwari and the information given by him, they won their case in front of SDM. This 25 hectare land was transferred to local people. This first win made Aruna Roy and her team made them understand the importance of information in their fight against corruption.

3. Your answer should include the following points:

- Incident of Dadi Rapat led to the formation of the MKSS.
- It started as a struggle for minimum wages of the workers employed at State Irrigation Department's site at Dadi Rapat.
- Despite their full work, workers were not given their bare minimum wages stipulated for that work.
- Aruna Roy's team investigated the issue and found many procedural lacunae in the measurement of the work and corruption done by officials.
- On the intervention of the MKSS, all 140 workers went on strike.
- State Famine Commissioner and Executive Engineer visited Dadi Rapat in 1989.
- Despite Commissioner's directions, workers continued to be paid lower wages than minimum.

- It was this realisation that led to the formation of the MKSS on the Labour Day i.e., May 1st, 1990. In a rally of 1000 people from 27 villages, the MKSS was formed with the objective of collective struggle against non-payment of minimum wages.

Check Your Progress 2

1. Your answer should include the following points:

- The MKSS' hunger strike in the town of Beawar in April 1996 led to the enactment of Right to Information Act in Rajasthan.
- Despite chief minister's promise, nothing concrete was done by the office of the director of panchayats.
- MKSS' historic 40 days long dharna demanded the political right of Right to Information, which was the basis of good governance. Instead of wages as compensation, people demanded the real power-the information of government records.
- People from all across Rajasthan started moving to Beawar.
- Cultural aspect of protest was noteworthy. Through puppet shows, devotional songs of *bhajan mandalies*, *nukkad nataks*, people started supporting the protesters and the demand for Right to Information.
- It became a people's struggle. They themselves collected money and all necessary things like food and health essentials.
- This protest caught the attention of the entire nation. People from different parts of the country like journalists, artists, lawyers started visiting Beawar.
- After continuous struggle, Rajasthan state's Right to Information Act was passed in May 2000.

2. Your answer should include the following points.

- Kot Kirana is a small village in Pali district.
- Here first *Jansunwai* was conducted on 2nd December 1994.
- MKSS demanded copies of all the muster rolls of Panchayat on the complaint of non-payment of wages.
- Sarpanch and secretary denied the copies, but they were provided by the BDO.
- When a number of anomalies were found in the records, its information was made public. An announcement of *Jansunwai* was made on 2nd December.
- Panchayat officials tried to make people hostile and distributed liquor, as bribe to ensure that no one would speak up at the hearing.
- As a reaction to prevalent corruption, people gathered in large numbers. They fearlessly spoke against the fraud and corruption exposed in the records. On the basis of people's affidavits, FIRs were filed.

- The MLA took the case to court to save the officials. Due to power of money and muscle, witnesses turned hostile and the case was closed. But this public hearing left an unforgettable mark in the history of India.
- It showed the strength of people's unified participation in exposing the shortcomings and corruption of the government.

Check Your Progress 3

1. Your answer should include the following points:

- Social audits are conducted by Gram Sabha.
- In social audits, all villagers gather to discuss and inspect the works of panchayats.
- Panchayat officials present the information on the works done by them and its total records in front of people.
- Villagers check if the information provided by officials is right or if there is any discrepancy in actual terms.
- During audit they demand any information related with works to be inspected.
- This increases transparency and could hold authorities accountable to public.
- Rajasthan government asked the MKSS to conduct about 6-8 social audits of the panchayats, where it spent a considerable amount during the previous year.
- State government provided the MKSS with all necessary information on expenditure and officers who incurred it.
- The MKSS' team visited village well in advance of social audit day. It gathered information about actual outlays of money. During audit all expenses were discussed.
- In proceedings of social audit, villagers determined if money was actually spent on the purpose shown in the accounts. This had a brought positive impact on government's working.

2. Your answer should include the following points.

- RTI has a direct relationship with accountability.
- When entire information is accessible to public, the officers may not do anything contrary to the rules or for their self-benefit.
- Through RTI and *Jansunwais*, the public can make officials accountable to them. They can check accounts, find discrepancies and question the officials in front of entire village.
- A public officer has no option but to answer all the questions. This type accountability forces administration to be vigilant and honest.
- This power holds the entire administration accountable to public for its every single penny.